

L30 — Graphs: Terminology, Adjacency Matrix, Path Matrix

Unit: 3 | Chapter: Graphs | BT Level: BT3 | CO: CO2

Learning Objectives

- Define graph terminology: vertices, edges, degree, path, cycle
 - Distinguish directed vs undirected, weighted vs unweighted graphs
 - Represent graphs using adjacency matrix and adjacency list
 - Compute the path matrix using matrix multiplication
-

1. Graph Fundamentals

A graph $G = (V, E)$ consists of:

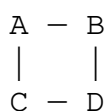
- V — a set of **vertices** (nodes)
- E — a set of **edges** (connections between vertices)

1.1 Key Terminology

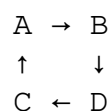
Term	Definition
Vertex (node)	Basic unit of a graph
Edge (arc)	Connection between two vertices
Adjacent	Two vertices connected by an edge
Degree	Number of edges incident to a vertex
In-degree	(Directed) Number of edges pointing into a vertex
Out-degree	(Directed) Number of edges pointing out of a vertex
Path	Sequence of vertices connected by edges
Simple path	Path with no repeated vertices
Cycle	Path that starts and ends at same vertex
Connected	There exists a path between every pair of vertices
Weighted graph	Each edge has a numerical weight
Directed graph (digraph)	Edges have a direction ($u \rightarrow v \neq v \rightarrow u$)

1.2 Types of Graphs

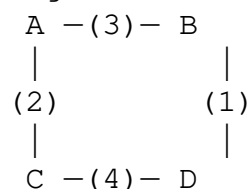
Undirected:



Directed:



Weighted:



1.3 Special Graphs

Type	Property
Simple graph	No loops or multiple edges
Complete graph K_n	Every pair of vertices is connected; $n(n-1)/2$ edges
Bipartite	Vertices split into 2 groups; edges only between groups
Tree	Connected graph with no cycles; $n-1$ edges for n vertices
DAG	Directed Acyclic Graph — no directed cycles

2. Graph Representation

2.1 Adjacency Matrix

An $n \times n$ matrix A where $A[i][j] = 1$ if edge (i,j) exists, else 0.

Undirected graph:

	A	B	C	D
A	[0	1	1	0]
B	[1	0	1	1]
C	[1	1	0	1]
D	[0	1	1	0]

Properties:

- Symmetric for undirected graphs ($A = A^T$)
- Space: $O(V^2)$
- Check edge (u,v) : $O(1)$
- Find all neighbors of u : $O(V)$

For weighted graphs: $A[i][j] = \text{weight}$ (or ∞ if no edge)

```
def build_adjacency_matrix(vertices, edges, directed=False):
    n = len(vertices)
    idx = {v: i for i, v in enumerate(vertices)}
    matrix = [[0] * n for _ in range(n)]

    for u, v in edges:
        matrix[idx[u]][idx[v]] = 1
        if not directed:
            matrix[idx[v]][idx[u]] = 1

    return matrix, idx

# Example
vertices = ['A', 'B', 'C', 'D']
edges = [('A', 'B'), ('A', 'C'), ('B', 'C'), ('B', 'D'), ('C', 'D')]
matrix, idx = build_adjacency_matrix(vertices, edges)

for row in matrix:
    print(row)
```

2.2 Adjacency List

Each vertex stores a list of its neighbors.

```
from collections import defaultdict

def build_adjacency_list(vertices, edges, directed=False):
    graph = defaultdict(list)

    for u, v in edges:
        graph[u].append(v)
        if not directed:
            graph[v].append(u)

    return dict(graph)

graph = build_adjacency_list(
    ['A', 'B', 'C', 'D'],
    [('A', 'B'), ('A', 'C'), ('B', 'C'), ('B', 'D'), ('C', 'D')]
)
# {'A': ['B', 'C'], 'B': ['A', 'C', 'D'], 'C': ['A', 'B', 'D'], 'D': ['C']}
```

Properties:

- Space: $O(V + E)$
- Find all neighbors of u : $O(\text{degree}(u))$
- Check if edge (u,v) exists: $O(\text{degree}(u))$

2.3 Comparison

Feature	Adjacency Matrix	Adjacency List
Space	$O(V^2)$	$O(V + E)$
Edge check	$O(1)$	$O(\text{degree})$
Find neighbors	$O(V)$	$O(\text{degree})$
Add edge	$O(1)$	$O(1)$ amortized
Best for	Dense graphs	Sparse graphs

3. Path Matrix (Transitive Closure)

The **path matrix** $P[i][j] = 1$ if there is a path from vertex i to vertex j (possibly multi-hop).

3.1 Using Matrix Multiplication

If A is the adjacency matrix, then $A^k[i][j]$ counts paths of exactly k hops from i to j .

The **reachability matrix** (Boolean path matrix) can be computed by:

$$P = A \vee A^2 \vee A^3 \vee \dots \vee A^{n-1}$$

where $\vee$ is element-wise OR (or sum > 0).

```

def matrix_multiply_bool(A, B, n):
    """Boolean matrix multiplication:  $C[i][j] = \text{OR of } (A[i][k] \text{ AND } B[k][j])$ 
     $C = [[0]*n \text{ for } \_ \text{ in range}(n)]$ 
    for i in range(n):
        for j in range(n):
            for k in range(n):
                if A[i][k] and B[k][j]:
                    C[i][j] = 1
    return C

def path_matrix_naive(adj, n):
    """Compute path matrix via repeated matrix multiplication."""
    #  $P = A \mid A^2 \mid A^3 \mid \dots \mid A^{(n-1)}$ 
    current = [row[:] for row in adj]    # Copy of A
    path = [row[:] for row in adj]      # Starts as A

    for _ in range(n - 2):    # Multiply n-2 more times
        current = matrix_multiply_bool(current, adj, n)
        for i in range(n):
            for j in range(n):
                path[i][j] |= current[i][j]

    # Add identity (i to i always reachable)
    for i in range(n):
        path[i][i] = 1

    return path

```

3.2 Warshall's Algorithm ($O(V^3)$)

More efficient: compute transitive closure directly.

```

def warshall(adj, n):
    """
    Warshall's algorithm for transitive closure (path matrix).
    Modifies adj in place.
    """
    P = [row[:] for row in adj]
    for i in range(n):
        P[i][i] = 1    # Every vertex is reachable from itself

    for k in range(n):    # Intermediate vertex
        for i in range(n):    # Source
            for j in range(n):    # Destination
                P[i][j] = P[i][j] or (P[i][k] and P[k][j])

    return P

```

Interpretation: $P[i][j] = 1$ iff there exists a path from i to j .

4. Degree Analysis

```

def degree_analysis(adj_list, directed=False):
    if not directed:
        degrees = {v: len(neighbors) for v, neighbors in adj_list.items}
        print("Degrees:", degrees)
        print("Handshake lemma: sum =", sum(degrees.values()), "(should
    else:
        out_degree = {v: len(neighbors) for v, neighbors in adj_list.it
        all_vertices = set(adj_list.keys())
        in_degree = {v: 0 for v in all_vertices}
        for v, neighbors in adj_list.items():
            for u in neighbors:
                in_degree[u] += 1
        print("Out-degrees:", out_degree)
        print("In-degrees:", in_degree)

```

Handshake Lemma: In an undirected graph, sum of all degrees = $2|E|$.

Summary

- Graph $G = (V, E)$; edges can be directed/undirected, weighted/unweighted.
 - **Adjacency matrix:** $O(V^2)$ space, $O(1)$ edge lookup — best for dense graphs.
 - **Adjacency list:** $O(V + E)$ space — best for sparse graphs.
 - **Path matrix:** $P[i][j] = 1$ iff path exists from i to j ; computed via Warshall's algorithm in $O(V^3)$.
-

References

- Cormen et al., *Introduction to Algorithms*, Ch. 22 (MIT Press, 2022)
- Skiena, *The Algorithm Design Manual*, Ch. 5 (Springer, 2020)